

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



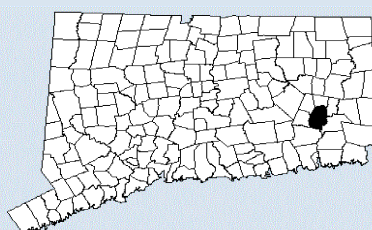
Norwich Free Academy District

Nathan Quesnel, Superintendent • 860-887-2505 • <http://www.nfaschool.org>

District Information

Grade Range	9-12
Number of Schools/Programs	4
Enrollment	2,071
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	N/A
Total Expenditures ¹	N/A

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	1,074	51.9	48.3
Male	983	47.5	51.5
Non-Binary	14	0.7	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	24	1.2	0.2
Asian	111	5.4	5.2
Black or African American	302	14.6	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	607	29.3	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	8	0.4	0.1
Two or More Races	132	6.4	4.7
White	887	42.8	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	276	13.3	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,159	56.0	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	248	12.0	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	249	23.4	*	*
Male	*	*	188	17.9
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	66	18.1	82	21.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	197	32.6	118	18.3
White	156	18.6	78	8.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	96	31.5	69	21.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	351	30.5	265	20.1
Students with Disabilities	95	40.6	73	25.7
District	472	23.0	321	14.5
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 492

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	135.1
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	10.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	19.2
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	12.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	6.5
School Level	14.9
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	2.0
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	0.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	22.6
School Nurses	4.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	104.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.5	0.1
Asian	5	2.5	1.4
Black or African American	12	5.9	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	6.4	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	171	84.7	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	13.1	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	77	91.7	66	93.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	151	88.8	138	92.6
White	234	97.9	224	98.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	68	74.7	66	82.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	275	91.1	252	94.7
Students with Disabilities	63	98.4	54	98.2
District	534	94.2	488	95.7
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.6
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.4
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.5
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	2.0
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	N/A	N/A	\$12,942
Support services - students	N/A	N/A	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	N/A	N/A	\$905
Support services - general administration	N/A	N/A	\$520
Support services - school based administration	N/A	N/A	\$1,207
Central and other support services	N/A	N/A	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	N/A	N/A	\$2,101
Student transportation services	N/A	N/A	\$1,582
Food services	N/A	N/A	\$8
Enterprise operations	N/A	N/A	\$213
Total	N/A	N/A	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	N/A	N/A	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	N/A	N/A	10.2
Other Salaries	N/A	N/A	10.5
Employee Benefits	N/A	N/A	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	N/A	N/A	6.4
Special Education Tuition	N/A	N/A	22.2
Supplies	N/A	N/A	0.7
Property Services	N/A	N/A	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	N/A	N/A	8.4
Equipment	N/A	N/A	0.3
All Other Expenditures	N/A	N/A	0.1
Total	N/A	N/A	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		N/A	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	N/A
State	N/A
Federal	N/A
Tuition & Other	N/A

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	32	65.1	32	62.0	32	72.2
Black or African American	63	40.1	63	35.6	63	40.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	132	41.4	132	36.6	132	42.7
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	38	44.6	38	39.4	37	51.5
White	236	59.0	236	51.6	236	63.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	66	32.9	66	32.2	63	37.1
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	441	54.1	441	47.4	443	57.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	241	43.2	241	38.5	243	44.8
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	266	58.8	266	51.7	263	64.1
Students with Disabilities	57	30.6	57	28.1	58	36.5
Students without Disabilities	450	54.0	450	47.7	448	57.2
High Needs	271	42.4	271	38.0	271	44.7
Non-High Needs	236	61.6	236	54.0	235	66.5
District	507	51.4	507	45.4	506	54.9

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	N/A	N/A	N/A	70.6	473	70.6
Curl Up	N/A	N/A	N/A	64.4	472	64.4
Push Up	N/A	N/A	N/A	60.3	471	60.3
Mile Run/PACER	N/A	N/A	N/A	42.8	472	42.8
All Tests - District	N/A	N/A	N/A	27.9	470	27.9
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	79	92.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	135	80.0
White	290	92.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	62	77.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	344	87.2
Students with Disabilities	83	73.5
District	559	89.8
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	206	36.9
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	28	18.1
Hispanic or Latino	55	17.2
White	235	50.3
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	8	4.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	118	20.8
Students with Disabilities	7	5.9
District	387	35.9
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	69.7	81.2
Male	55.3	71.5
Non-Binary	*	N/A
Black or African American	58.1	68.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	46.8	*
White	67.2	80.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	47.1	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	54.5	68.7
Students with Disabilities	39.3	*
District	63.0	76.6
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	51.4	75	102.7	150	68.5	63.9
	High Needs Students	42.4	75	84.8	150	56.5	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	45.4	75	90.9	150	60.6	60.2
	High Needs Students	38.0	75	76.0	150	50.7	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	54.9	75	73.2	100	73.2	61.8
	High Needs Students	44.7	75	59.7	100	59.7	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	.	100%	.	.	.	58.7%
	High Needs Students	.	100%	.	.	.	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	.	100%	.	.	.	61.4%
	High Needs Students	.	100%	.	.	.	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	43.4%	100%	21.7	50	43.4	58.9%
	Oral	41.1%	100%	20.5	50	41.1	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	23.0%	<=5%	14.0	50	28.0	17.7%
	High Needs Students	30.1%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	94.9%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	35.9%	75%	24.0	50	47.9	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		83.6%	94%	44.5	50	89.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		89.8%	94%	95.5	100	95.5	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		88.5%	94%	94.1	100	94.1	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		63.0%	75%	84.0	100	84.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		96.0% 27.9%	75%	18.6	50	37.2	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		54.8%	60%	45.7	50	91.4	55.0%
Accountability Index				999.9	1550	64.5	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	61.6	42.4	19.2	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	54.0	38.0	16.0	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	66.5	44.7	21.8	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	88.5%	5.5%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	96.0
	High Needs Students	93.3
Math	All Students	96.0
	High Needs Students	93.3
Science	All Students	96.8
	High Needs Students	95.1

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: N/A

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Our school improvement plan for 2023/24 identified three main priorities: Advance Achievement for All Students, Inspire a Culture of Engagement and Operate with Excellence. We worked on several projects aligned with these priorities including implementing a shared understanding of high quality instruction, improving student attendance and behavior, developing a strategic vision plan, increasing student enrollment and improving relationships with our partner districts.

At the start of this school year, we merged the School Counseling and Student Services departments into one Student Support Services department in order to streamline the coordination of the functions of each of those departments. The special education teachers in our resource program were split into two groups—co-teaching and case management. This division of responsibilities allowed the teachers to focus on one responsibility while allowing for collaboration with other teachers in the same role. We also took over the responsibility of hiring our own paraprofessionals from our partner districts. This allowed us to have more oversight of the support in our special programs. In response to the needs of our current student population, the department also spent time this year planning for a program restructure for the upcoming 24/25 school year. Our current five special education programs will be collapsed into three programs to provide a stronger continuum of services and to promote more time in the general education setting as appropriate. In addition, NFA developed a new special education program for next school year which is specifically designed for students who are unable to meet their maximum potential in the traditional classroom setting and need added behavioral and emotional support in a smaller environment. Our Student Support Services department partnered with SERC, CT Center for School Safety and PD Monster to participate in multiple trainings this year aimed at improving our understanding of the IEP, UDL, De-Escalation, Crisis Management and Risk Assessments.

At the start of this year, we created a new 9th grade On-Track Counselor position who worked closely with students identified as being off track in the areas of behavior, academics and/or attendance. Our grade level support teams implemented daily phone calls to targeted students with attendance issues. Members of the support teams participated in LEAP home visit training in preparation for our participation in the next LEAP cohort.

As part of our NEASC visit in the fall and in preparation for creating a strategic vision plan for next year, caregivers and community members were invited to participate in focus groups to provide feedback on their school experience and to identify their priorities.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

NFA has had a focus on international student recruitment and has commitments from new students for next school year representing the following countries: Spain, China, Finland, Canada, France and Greece.

NFA has developed a strategic plan focused on recruiting, hiring, and retaining high-quality educators of color for the 24-25 year, addressing three critical areas.

Because of the overrepresentation of students of color in our lower-level core academic courses, we have eliminated all levels in our 9th, 10th and 11th grade core courses besides college prep and honors.

The 23 teachers of our sheltered ML classes received training on effective instructional strategies for teaching multilingual learners. To better support the specific needs of our ML student population, we created a Multilingual Learners MTSS team to monitor student progress.

NFA students planned the first "NFA Around the Globe" event in the spring. All students were exposed to the different cultures represented by our student population through cultural performances and activities. Our semi-weekly Community Meeting presentations include student-related videos educating our school community on different cultures and celebrations.

Students of any background are invited and encouraged to join any of our 7 clubs focused on language and culture. In addition, we recognize and participate in the following events and programs: NAACP Harmony Classic Event, The Great Debate, Haitian Flag Day, Hispanic Heritage Month, Cape Verdean Festival, Martin Luther King Luncheon and March, Black History Month, Historical Black Colleges Tour, Haitian Refugees Service Program.

All students were issued an NFA Chromebook to be used throughout their high school years.

Approximately 10 students were offered summer internships at Dime Bank, Core Plus Credit Union and the City of Norwich.

The Wildcat Loft allows all students free access to clothing, hygiene products and school supplies regardless of need. At least 1750 transactions were conducted this school year. Similarly, the NFA Food Pantry exists to combat food insecurity for any NFA student. Approximately 1880 food bags were sent home this school year on a weekly basis. The Wildcat Loft collaborates with United Way in order to assess ongoing community needs.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

NFA is a comprehensive independent high school that has a Master Educational Agreement with the Boards of Education from eight local Partner Communities. To that end, NFA is regarded as a single school district (one high school) that serves students from approximately twenty-one CT communities.